
ELECTION METHODS DETAILS

Method 1

Method 1 allows voters to cast their vote remotely over the internet, using mobile app, a standard web browser, or both - depending on which devices voters have available. In every case, the voter's identity is confirmed before the ballot is released, using a combination of email verification, a one-time passcode (OTP), and/or a unique ballot link. Method 1 offers three configurable election types, described below.

Type 1 - Mobile App Based

Voters verify their identity and cast their vote entirely mobile application. Verification is done using the voter's registered email together with an OTP delivered by SMS to the voter's registered mobile number.

Voter flow

1. Voter installs the official mobile app
2. The system sends a one-time passcode (OTP) by SMS to the voter's registered mobile number.
3. The voter enters the OTP in the app to complete identity verification.
4. Once verified, the voter is shown the verification and confirm the voter list and can see the election details.

Note: Requires the voter to have the mobile app installed and a valid, reachable mobile number.

Type 2 - Web Based

Voters verify their identity and vote from any internet browser, without installing an app. Verification is done by email OTP, after which a unique, single-use ballot link is sent to the voter's registered email address.

Voter flow

1. Voter receives an election notification and requests an OTP to their registered email address.
2. The voter enters the OTP on the web portal to complete identity verification.
3. Once verified, the voter is shown the verification and confirm the voter list and can see the election details.
4. The system emails the voter a unique ballot link.
5. The voter opens the link in a browser, accesses the ballot, and casts their vote.

Note: No app installation is required - only a working email inbox and an internet-connected browser.

Type 3 - Both Mobile and Web (Hybrid)

This type lets a single election serve every voter regardless of which device they have, by automatically choosing the verification path per voter:

- **If the voter has the mobile app installed:** they are verified using email + SMS OTP and vote inside the app, exactly as in Type 1.

- **If the voter does not install the app:** they are verified using email OTP only, and receive a ballot link by email to vote through their browser, exactly as in Type 2.

This removes the need for the organization to run two separate elections or force every voter onto the same channel - each voter is automatically routed through whichever verification path matches their device.

Organization Visibility - Verification Status Dashboard

For all three types under Method 1, the organization's admin dashboard displays the mobile app verification status as a graphical breakdown within the voter list - for example, how many voters have verified through the app versus through email/web. This gives election administrators real-time visibility into voter verification progress.

Method 2 - Venue / Device-Based Voting

Method 2 is a supervised, in-person election held at a physical election venue. Instead of voting from their own device, voters cast their ballot on devices - laptops or iPads - provided and set up by the organization at the venue. This method suits elections that require tighter physical control and on-site supervision, such as annual general meetings, conferences, or on-site union or society elections.

Key Components

Component	Description
Election Venue	The designated physical location where voting takes place.
Voting Devices ("Booths")	Multiple laptops or iPads set up at the venue, each functioning as an independent voting booth. All devices are connected to the internet simultaneously so several voters can vote in parallel.
Voter Unique ID	A unique ID issued to each voter, used to unlock the voting screen on any available device/booth at the venue.
Optional Verification (manually or physically)	An additional, optional layer of identity confirmation - an SMS OTP and/or an email confirmation link - that can be switched on for elections that need stronger assurance.

Voter Flow

1. Voter arrives at the election venue and get their unique code.
2. Voter goes to any available device/booth.
3. Voter enters their unique voter ID to unlock that device's voting screen.
4. If enabled by the organization, the system sends an OTP by SMS and/or an email confirmation link as a second identity check.
5. Once verified, the voter casts their vote on the device.
6. The device screen locks/resets, ready for the next voter.

Note: OTP and email-link verification are optional add-ons in Method 2 - the unique voter ID unlocking the device is the baseline verification step.

Method 1 vs. Method 2 - At a Glance

Aspect	Method 1 - Online / Remote	Method 2 - Venue / Device-Based
Voting location	Anywhere with an internet connection	Fixed election venue only
Device used	Voter's own mobile phone or computer	Organization-provided laptop/iPad at the venue
Primary identity check	Email OTP (plus mobile SMS OTP when the app is used)	Unique voter ID (unlocks the device screen)
Secondary verification	Ballot link sent by email (Web type)	Optional SMS OTP and/or email confirmation link
Supervision	Unsupervised - self-service, remote	Supervised - staff present at the venue
Best suited for	Geographically spread voters; convenience-first elections	Centralized, in-person elections needing tighter physical control (AGMs, conferences, on-site elections)

Glossary of Terms

Term	Meaning
OTP	One-Time Passcode - a short code sent by SMS or generated for a single verification attempt, used to confirm the voter is who they claim to be.
Ballot Link	A unique, single-use web link emailed to a verified voter, which opens their ballot in a browser.
Voter Unique ID	An ID assigned to each registered voter, used in Method 2 to unlock a voting device/booth.
Booth / Device	A laptop or iPad set up at the election venue in Method 2, functioning as one independent voting station.
Election Venue	The physical location where Method 2 voting takes place.